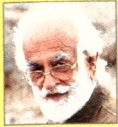
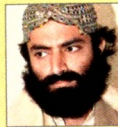


Resistance Movements



BALUCHISTAN LIBERATION ARMY

Allegedly formed in 2000 by Balach Marri and supported by Nawab Akbar Khan Bugti's militias. After Balach's death, his brother Herbiyar is accused of running it from London.



BALUCH REPUBLICAN PARTY

Headed by Brahmdagh Bugti and considered an off-shoot of the Balochistan Liberation Army. Operates mainly in Dera Bugti and Quetta. Brahmdagh is believed to be in hiding in Kabul.

ALLEGED INDIAN INVOLVEMENT

Pakistan accuses India of using its consulates in Zahedan in Iran and Kandahar in Afghanistan to foment trouble in Balochistan

Mining Wealth

The region is Pakistan's richest source of natural resources



GAS

Supplies all of Pakistan



GOLD

One of the largest deposits in the world



COPPER

Significant exports for Pakistan



PORT

Gwadar is a strategic port

Graphic by PRASHANT CHAUDHARY

"insulting behaviour" of the security personnel. The Balochistan Frontier Corps (FC), the pre-eminent law enforcement agency in the province, was only asked to handle security in the provincial capital on June 29 this year after a spate of targeted killings.

Quetta, in fact, is largely a Pashtun city, especially after the influx of Afghan refugees. In spite of this, or precisely because of it, the Baloch question is what the current strife is all about. Balochistan province—which only came into being in 1970 with the amalgamation of largely autonomous tribal fiefdoms—is the biggest province by far

in Pakistan, comprising approximately 44 per cent of the total land mass. Yet, it contains less than 7 per cent of the country's population. Of that, only about half is Baloch, mostly concentrated in the "Baloch belt" in the south, east, south-eastern and south-western parts of the province. Not only do the Baloch feel they are being made a minority in their own province, they feel their province has been discriminated against, economically and socially.

Because of a number of reasons, including the difficult terrain and sparseness of the population, Balochistan has remained a severely underdeveloped area with generally the worst social indicators in the whole country. Many commentators, including some Baloch nationalists, have accused the tribal sardars or chiefs—who command almost totalitarian authority in their areas—of impeding development in

Punjab province, of exploiting the natural resources of the province without adequate compensation.

Many of the accusations made by Baloch politicians—who are dominated by the same tribal sardars—are political rhetoric, designed to present themselves as patriotic nationalists to their domestic constituents. But on the issue of natural resources, they have a point. Natural gas, discovered in 1963 in the Sui area of Dera Bugti, supplies all of Pakistan. Yet, the Balochistan government is only paid 12.5 per cent royalty for this energy resource and most parts of Dera Bugti district itself still do not have piped gas. The province also has one of the largest copper and gold deposits in the world in the Chagai district near the Iran border. Yet the two main extraction projects at Reko Diq and Saindak, operated jointly with international



**VIOLENT
PROTESTS
ERUPTED IN
PAKISTAN
FOLLOWING
THE DEATH OF
BUGTI TRIBAL
CHIEF NAWAB
AKBAR KHAN
BUGTI**

their areas to preserve their subjects dependence on them. Others point to the lack of capacity. For example, during General Pervez Musharraf's tenure as president, Rs 350 billion were allocated for Balochistan in seven years in the federal development budget—compared to the mere Rs 129 billion allocated in the 29 years before it—yet the actual deployment on the ground was much less because the ability to utilise it was missing. Increasingly, however, Baloch politicians blame Islamabad for the underdevelopment, accusing the federation, and in particular the most populous

companies from Italy, Australia and China, pay only a small royalty to the provincial government. None of the substantial transit trade that plies between Afghanistan and Iran and the rest of Pakistan pays any duty to the provincial government. It is also speculated that large oil reserves lie untapped in parts of Balochistan and Baloch leaders allege that Pakistan's civil and military bureaucracy has its eye on them as well. They also claim, correctly, that the mega-projects in the province often bypass the local population and also utilise non-local labour rather than providing jobs to residents.